

Reviewer Pack — Plateau-Duration Lemma: $T_{\text{plateau}} \geq |S|/4$ for DP on Tseitin

Entry 78a0daff2b40 · INCONCLUSIVE

SEC autonomous research engine — attribution: Ludovico Kubler

2026-05-29 11:25:17 UTC

Plateau-Duration Lemma: $T_{\text{plateau}} \geq |S|/4$ for DP on Tseitin

Entry ID: 78a0daff2b40 Verdict: INCONCLUSIVE Recorded: 2026-05-29 11:25:17 UTC

1. Conjecture

Field A (mathematical branch): Separator / treewidth lower bounds **Field B** (complexity object): Davis-Putnam resolution

Statement:

Let G be a connected 3-regular graph on n vertices, let $|S(G)|$ denote the minimum balanced vertex separator size (smallest $|S|$ such that every component of $G \setminus S$ has at most $2n/3$ vertices), and let $T(G, c)$ be the Tseitin CNF with odd charge c . For every Davis-Putnam variable-elimination resolution refutation π of $T(G, c)$ with proof states $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_L$ and active-clause counts $a_t := |\text{activeClauses}(\sigma_t)|$, the high-activity plateau duration $T_{\text{plateau}}(\pi) := |\{t : a_t \geq |S(G)|/4\}|$ satisfies $T_{\text{plateau}}(\pi) \geq |S(G)|/4$. A single triple $(G, c, \text{elimination order})$ producing $T_{\text{plateau}} < \lceil |S(G)|/4 \rceil$ falsifies the conjecture.

Rationale (proposer's reasoning):

SC2 demands $\Phi(\pi) = \sum_t a_t \geq c \cdot |S|^2$, a peak-times-duration quantity. The peak factor $\max_t a_t \geq \Omega(|S|)$ is already accessible via Alekhovich-Razborov-style expansion/separator arguments, so the missing inferential step is precisely a duration lower bound: the high-activity regime must persist for $\Omega(|S|)$ variable-elimination steps. Establishing this linear-in- $|S|$ plateau lemma turns the known peak bound into the desired quadratic Φ -bound by a one-line product, advancing SC2 by exactly one step.

Taxonomy category: c003b_cumulative_entropy (status at proposal time:)

2. Pre-registration (Popper-style)

Hash (SHA-256 prefix): d241a06f80d1387d

This hash commits to the conjecture statement, acceptance criterion, and seed list **before** the empirical test runs. Tampering with the test or its data after this hash was computed would be detectable.

Acceptance criterion:

Across all 7 sizes $n \in \{8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20\} \times 30$ seeds = 210 random cubic Tseitin instances, for each instance compute T_{plateau} under 3 DP elimination orders (min-deg, max-deg, random). Support iff every (instance, order) satisfies $T_{\text{plateau}} \geq \lceil |S(G)|/4 \rceil$.

3. Barrier filter (F1)

Final: PASS

Barrier	Verdict	Confidence	LLM ₁	LLM ₂
RELATIVIZATION	SAFE	0.95	SAFE	SAFE
NATURAL_PROOFS	SAFE	0.95	SAFE	SAFE
ALGEBRIZATION	SAFE	0.92	SAFE	SAFE
KARP_LIPTON	SAFE	0.95	SAFE	SAFE

4. Novelty audit

Verdict: NOVEL against 0 hits across arXiv + Semantic Scholar + ECCC

Search queries (3): - Tseitin formulas resolution width treewidth lower bound - Davis Putnam variable elimination separator width Tseitin - resolution refutation space clause width balanced separator 3-regular Tseitin

5. Empirical test harness

Multi-seed protocol: 5 seeds (11, 23, 37, 53, 71)

Sandbox: isolated subprocess, stdlib-only, ≤90s wall time per cycle **Execution:** rc=0, elapsed=0.4s

5.1 Generated Python source

```
#!/usr/bin/env python3
"""C-003b cumulative entropy – FAITHFUL reference harness.

Computes the REAL cumulative proof entropy
  Phi(pi) = sum_t |activeClauses(sigma_t)|
over an actual resolution refutation (Davis-Putnam variable elimination)
of Tseitin formulas, exactly per the Lean definitions in Conjecture003.lean:
  proofStateEntropy(sigma) := sigma.activeClauses.card
  cumulativeEntropy(states) := sum (map proofStateEntropy states)
plus the width-aware totalLiteralWeight version (sum of clause sizes).

This is NOT the CDCL clause-count proxy used by the old c003b_counterexample.py:
it tracks the active clause database at EVERY elimination step of a genuine
resolution derivation, so it is the actual Phi the formalization names.

Pure stdlib (no networkx/pysat), so it runs in the pipeline sandbox.
Protocol: run_trial(seed)->dict with TRIAL/RESULT lines.

Author: Ludovico Kubler (harness by the SEC engine, hand-verified).
NOTE: no `from __future__ import annotations` – the sandbox injects a prelude
above the file, which would break that statement's must-be-first rule.
"""

import json
import math
import random
import sys

Clause = frozenset # a clause = frozenset of signed ints (var or -var)
```

```

# ----- Tseitin formula generation -----

def random_regular_graph(n: int, degree: int, rng: random.Random):
    """Simple random regular graph via configuration model with retries."""
    if (n * degree) % 2 != 0:
        n += 1
    for _ in range(200):
        stubs = []
        for v in range(n):
            stubs += [v] * degree
        rng.shuffle(stubs)
        edges = set()
        ok = True
        for i in range(0, len(stubs), 2):
            u, w = stubs[i], stubs[i + 1]
            if u == w or (min(u, w), max(u, w)) in edges:
                ok = False
                break
            edges.add((min(u, w), max(u, w)))
        if ok and len(edges) == n * degree // 2:
            return n, sorted(edges)
    # fallback: cycle + chords
    edges = {(i, (i + 1) % n) for i in range(n)}
    return n, sorted((min(a, b), max(a, b)) for a, b in edges)

def tseitin_cnf(n: int, edges: list, charge: dict) -> list:
    """Tseitin CNF over edge variables (1-indexed). For each vertex, clauses
    enforce parity of incident edges = charge[v]."""
    evar = {}
    for i, (u, v) in enumerate(edges):
        evar[(u, v)] = i + 1
        evar[(v, u)] = i + 1
    inc = {v: [] for v in range(n)}
    for (u, v) in edges:
        inc[u].append(evar[(u, v)])
        inc[v].append(evar[(u, v)])
    clauses = []
    for v in range(n):
        vars_ = inc[v]
        k = len(vars_)
        tgt = charge.get(v, 0)
        for mask in range(1 << k):
            if bin(mask).count("1") % 2 != tgt:
                cl = []
                for j, var in enumerate(vars_):
                    cl.append(-var if (mask >> j) & 1 else var)
                clauses.append(frozenset(cl))
    return clauses

# ----- Resolution by Davis-Putnam variable elimination -----

def resolve(c1: frozenset, c2: frozenset, var: int):
    """Resolvent of c1, c2 on var (c1 has +var, c2 has -var). None if tautology."""
    r = (c1 - {var}) | (c2 - {-var})

```

```

for lit in r:
    if -lit in r:
        return None # tautology
return frozenset(r)

def dp_refutation_phi(clauses: list, rng: random.Random):
    """Run DP elimination in min-occurrence order; track the active clause DB
    after each elimination. Returns (phi_count, phi_weight, n_steps, derived_empty).

    phi_count = sum_t |DB_t| (proofStateEntropy = card)
    phi_weight = sum_t sum_{C in DB_t} |C| (totalLiteralWeight version)
    """
    db = set(clauses)
    variables = set(abs(l) for c in db for l in c)
    phi_count = len(db)
    phi_weight = sum(len(c) for c in db)
    n_steps = 1
    derived_empty = frozenset() in db
    MAX_DB = 200000 # guard against blow-up on bad instances

    while variables and not derived_empty:
        # min-occurrence elimination order (standard good heuristic)
        occ = {v: 0 for v in variables}
        for c in db:
            for l in c:
                if abs(l) in occ:
                    occ[abs(l)] += 1
        var = min(variables, key=lambda v: occ[v])
        variables.discard(var)

        pos = [c for c in db if var in c]
        neg = [c for c in db if -var in c]
        others = [c for c in db if var not in c and -var not in c]

        resolvents = set()
        for cp in pos:
            for cn in neg:
                r = resolve(cp, cn, var)
                if r is not None:
                    resolvents.add(r)
                    if len(r) == 0:
                        derived_empty = True
        new_db = set(others) | resolvents
        # forward subsumption (keep minimal clauses) – cheap pass
        db = new_db
        phi_count += len(db)
        phi_weight += sum(len(c) for c in db)
        n_steps += 1
        if len(db) > MAX_DB:
            break

    return phi_count, phi_weight, n_steps, derived_empty

# ----- Separator (cheap balanced-ish) -----

```

```

def approx_separator_size(n: int, edges: list) -> int:
    """Cheap proxy for balanced separator size: min vertices whose removal
    splits the graph ~in half. We use a simple BFS-layer cut."""
    adj = {v: set() for v in range(n)}
    for (u, v) in edges:
        adj[u].add(v); adj[v].add(u)
    # BFS from 0, cut at the layer crossing the median
    from collections import deque
    seen = {0}; layer = {0: 0}; q = deque([0])
    while q:
        x = q.popleft()
        for y in adj[x]:
            if y not in seen:
                seen.add(y); layer[y] = layer[x] + 1; q.append(y)
    if len(seen) < n: # disconnected
        return 0
    half = n // 2
    # vertices on the boundary between the first ~half and the rest
    order = sorted(range(n), key=lambda v: layer.get(v, 0))
    side_a = set(order[:half])
    cut = set()
    for (u, v) in edges:
        if (u in side_a) != (v in side_a):
            cut.add(u if u not in side_a else v)
    return len(cut)

```

----- Trial protocol -----

```

def run_trial(seed: int) -> dict:
    rng = random.Random(seed)
    # sweep several small sizes; report the scaling exponent of Phi vs n
    ns = [6, 8, 10, 12, 14]
    data = []
    for n0 in ns:
        n, edges = random_regular_graph(n0, 3, rng)
        charge = {v: 0 for v in range(n)}
        charge[0] = 1 # odd total -> UNSAT
        clauses = tseitin_cnf(n, edges, charge)
        phi_c, phi_w, steps, empty = dp_refutation_phi(clauses, rng)
        sep = approx_separator_size(n, edges)
        data.append({"n": n, "m_edges": len(edges), "sep": sep,
                    "phi_count": phi_c, "phi_weight": phi_w,
                    "steps": steps, "derived_empty": empty})
    # scaling: log-log slope of phi_count vs n
    xs = [math.log(d["n"]) for d in data if d["phi_count"] > 0]
    ys = [math.log(d["phi_count"]) for d in data if d["phi_count"] > 0]
    if len(xs) >= 2:
        mx = sum(xs) / len(xs); my = sum(ys) / len(ys)
        num = sum((x - mx) * (y - my) for x, y in zip(xs, ys))
        den = sum((x - mx) ** 2 for x in xs)
        slope = num / den if den else 0.0
    else:
        slope = 0.0
    biggest = data[-1]

```

```

# Sub-conjecture under test (SC1):  $\Phi \geq \text{sep}^2$  on the largest instance
# (a concrete, falsifiable scaling claim derived from the C-003b thesis
# that cumulative entropy is forced by the separator).
holds = biggest["phi_count"] >= max(1, biggest["sep"]) ** 2
return {
    "metric_name": "phi_count_loglog_slope_vs_n",
    "metric_value": round(slope, 4),
    "instances_tested": len(ns),
    "n_max": max(ns),
    "conjecture_holds": holds,
    "counterexample": "" if holds else
        f"n={biggest['n']} sep={biggest['sep']} phi={biggest['phi_count']} < sep^2",
    "detail": data,
}

if __name__ == "__main__":
    seeds = [int(x) for x in sys.argv[1:]] or [11, 23, 37]
    results = []
    for s in seeds:
        r = run_trial(s)
        results.append(r)
        print("TRIAL: " + json.dumps(r))
    slopes = [r["metric_value"] for r in results]
    holds = sum(1 for r in results if r["conjecture_holds"])
    mean = sum(slopes) / len(slopes)
    if holds == len(results):
        print(f"RESULT: SUPPORTED mean_slope={mean:.4f} support_fraction=1.0")
    elif holds == 0:
        print(f"RESULT: FALSIFIED counterexample=\"phi < sep^2\" first_failing_seed={seeds[0]}")
    else:
        print(f"RESULT: INCONCLUSIVE mixed holds={holds}/{len(results)} mean_slope={mean:.4f}")

```

6. Per-seed results

Seed	Metric value	Holds?	Counterexample
?	2.4348	□	
?	2.0177	□	
?	2.0528	□	
?	2.4751	□	
?	2.4691	□	
?	2.2173	□	
?	2.2983	□	
?	2.7629	□	
?	2.3782	□	
?	2.7571	□	
?	2.6234	□	
?	2.5729	□	
?	2.3297	□	

Aggregate statistics:

Statistic	Value
n_seeds	13
metric_mean	2.4145615384615384
metric_std	0.23518233897149377
metric_ci95_half	0.13045568957619594
metric_min	2.0177
metric_max	2.7629
support_fraction	1.0

7. Test stdout (last 2KB)

```
"m_edges": 15, "sep": 3, "phi_count": 591, "phi_weight": 2826, "steps": 16, "derived_empty": true}, {"
TRIAL: {"metric_name": "phi_count_loglog_slope_vs_n", "metric_value": 2.2983, "instances_tested": 5,
TRIAL: {"metric_name": "phi_count_loglog_slope_vs_n", "metric_value": 2.7629, "instances_tested": 5,
TRIAL: {"metric_name": "phi_count_loglog_slope_vs_n", "metric_value": 2.3782, "instances_tested": 5,
```

8. Critic adversarial review

Critic verdict: CHALLENGE

Critic reasoning:

The conjecture concerns the plateau duration $T_{\text{plateau}}(n) := |\{t : a_t \geq |S(G)|/4\}|$ and asserts $T_{\text{plateau}} \geq |S|/4$ for a single proof n . The test instead reports `phi_count_loglog_slope_vs_n` — a log-log regression slope of cumulative entropy $\Phi = \sum a_t$ versus n across 5 instances. That metric is neither T_{plateau} nor the $|S|/4$ threshold; values like 2.41 are an asymptotic exponent, not a comparison of T_{plateau} to $|S|/4$. The reported `holds: true` therefore does not test the stated inequality a

9. Final verdict & safety rail

Verdict: INCONCLUSIVE

Reasoning:

The test reports a log-log slope of cumulative Φ vs n (~ 2.41) over only 5 instances with one elimination order, not the pre-registered $T_{\text{plateau}} \geq |S(G)|/4$ check across 630 runs (7 sizes $\times$ 30 seeds $\times$ 3 orderings). The stated inequality is never directly evaluated, so the support condition is not unambiguously met. | next: Re-run the pre-registered protocol that, for each of the 210 instances under all 3 DP elimination orders, directly computes $T_{\text{plateau}}(n) = |\{t : a_t \geq |S(G)|/4\}|$ and checks T

11. Audit log (LLM calls)

Total LLM calls: 6

#	Phase	Provider	Model	Tokens in	out	Latency (ms)
1	propose	claude_max	opus	0	0	61599
2	preregistration	claude_max	opus	0	0	4956
3	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	3175
4	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	6119
5	critic	claude_max	opus	0	0	15952
6	judge	claude_max	opus	0	0	9087

Totals: 0 input tokens, 0 output tokens, $\sim \$0.0000$ cost, 100888 ms total latency. Provider mix: `{'claude_max': 6}`

(full prompt+response transcripts available in `research/audit/78a0daff2b40.jsonl`)

12. Reproducibility

To reproduce this cycle:

1. Apply the test harness in section 5.1 with seeds 11,23,37,53,71
2. The Python sandbox is pure-stdlib; any Python 3.11+ should suffice
3. The full LLM transcripts are in `research/audit/78a0daff2b40.jsonl` for verification of provenance
4. The pre-registration hash in section 2 commits to the test design before execution; tampering would be detectable.

Sandbox file: `research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_*.py` (per-cycle)

Replay tarball: `research/replay/78a0daff2b40.tar.gz` (if generated)